



PURUSHOTTOM DWIVAKAR

African. (In fact, company Director Bob Nicholls and six other bodyguards were among the hundreds of guests at the Taj Mahal on the night of November 26 and helped evacuate 120 guests down 25 floors). Numbers of security personnel vary at a match in South Africa, Centurion once pulling in 1,100 (including police) for the 2003 India v/s Pakistan World Cup game while Kingsmead, Durban, has between 150 to 300 securitymen inside the ground with police and sniffer dog support outside.

The morning after the IPL's South African move was announced, telephones at the Kwa Zulu Natal (KZN) Cricket Union began ringing with queries about hospitality suites and tickets. "The demand has been so great in such a short span of time. Our season has just been extended, but everything is in place, we're ready to go," says Cassim Docrat, CEO, KZN.

Durban, with its vast Indian population, is expected to host between 8-10 games, including perhaps a semi-final. The IPL will move the event and squads around six venues, the first half of the event held mostly in the colder cities. "It is a pity that we won't be 'adopting' a team. We were looking forward to establishing links with IPL squads," says Docrat, "but opportunities will surely crop up in the future."

by Sharda Ugra

WHAT'S THE DRAMA ABOUT TV RIGHTS?

AVERAGE TRP FOR IPL

- 4.7** 59 matches between April 18 and May 31
- 9.8** TRP of Finals, June 1 (Compared to 15.8 for T-20 World Championships in 2007)
- 6.3** TRP of semi-finals, May 31
- 6.2** TRP of semi-finals, May 30

101 million
cumulative reach
of all matches

WHO WATCHED WHAT

Age-groups of IPL watchers

- 39%** 35 plus
- 25%** 15-24
- 20%** 25-34
- 16%** 4-14

IT'S A MALE THING

64% **36%**
MEN WOMEN

All data from TAM

What attracted viewers most? 25 per cent said it was the shorter duration.
Why did viewers watch IPL? 41 per cent, the highest, said it was because it symbolises their city.
What did they give up? 50 per cent said they made TV compromises. 42 per cent of those who switched to IPL gave up family soaps.
Did it create team loyalty? 83 per cent said they intend to support a particular team this season.

Mindshare-Synovate data

It was a drama with more twists and turns than a T-20 match and it certainly lasted longer. At its centre was IPL Commissioner Lalit Modi, who like Oliver, wanted more. Lots more. Not content with having signed a deal with the Singapore-based World Sport Group (wsg) for 10 years for \$918 million (Rs 3,600 crore at the exchange rate in January 2008) plus an additional \$108 million from wsg and Sony Entertainment Television towards marketing expenses, he managed to renegotiate it with them for \$1.64 billion (Rs 8,200 crore) for nine years, just in time to offset the increased costs incurred in hosting the championship in South Africa, making it the biggest cricket telecast deal in India ever. Sony will now be required to pay a stupendous Rs 2,700 crore over the first four years and Rs 5,500 crore over the next five years. It will require an ambitious second season every year.

How Modi got Sony to sign on a veritable suicide pact is a tribute to his manipulative skills, which saw him getting into partnership with former enemies and stepping out of deals with avowed friends. All in the space of a few vertiginous weeks. The resulting mess got long-time CEO Kunal Dasgupta to walk out of Sony, got Sony to hotfoot it to the Bombay High Court, and created new suitors, led by sports buff and NDTV Chairman Prannoy Roy who was the face for a consortium comprising Dentsu Communications, Aircel and Providence Capital, and ESPN's Manu Sawhney, both of whom had bid unsuccessfully for IPL in 2008 as well.

Modi's aim was to put pressure on a desperate Sony and extract a higher price. Yet when the tender process was opened last year, the IPL was an untested property. No one thought it would become the phenomenon it did, getting an average TRP of 4.7 between April 18 and May 31 last year, a cumulative reach of 101 million households and a revenue of Rs 238 crore for Sony. The BCCI, which runs the IPL, had issued a tender for it with a reserve price of \$59 million (Rs 230 crore at the exchange rate in January 2008). wsg, a private company co-owned by an \$8-billion French conglomerate, Lagardere, and the Japanese ad agency Dentsu won it, leasing the India and South Asia rights to Sony for \$54 million a year